Google Drive API v3

Capabilities and documentation summary (picked from the Google Cloud API Library)

1. Overview

The Google Drive API lets applications read, write, organise, share and monitor files stored in Google Drive and shared drives. It is a REST API (JSON over HTTPS) with official client libraries for Java, Python, Node.js, Go, .NET, PHP, Ruby and more. Enable it in the Cloud Console under **APIs & Services > Library > Google Drive API**.

Item	Value
Service name	drive.googleapis.com (API version v3)
Service endpoint	https://www.googleapis.com
Base path	https://www.googleapis.com/drive/v3/...
Upload path	https://www.googleapis.com/upload/drive/v3/...
Discovery document	https://www.googleapis.com/discovery/v1/apis/drive/v3/rest
Authentication	OAuth 2.0 (user consent or service account with domain-wide delegation)

2. What you can do with it

• **Upload and download files**: simple, multipart and resumable uploads; download raw content of any file.

• **Export Google Workspace files**: convert Docs, Sheets, Slides, etc. to PDF, DOCX, XLSX, CSV and other MIME types.

• **Search** for files and folders with rich queries over any metadata field (name, mimeType, owners, modifiedTime, parents, labels and more).

• **Organise**: create folders, move files between parents, copy, rename, trash/untrash and permanently delete files.

• **Share** files, folders and shared drives by creating, updating and removing permissions (user, group, domain, anyone).

• **Shared drives**: create, list, update, hide/unhide and delete team shared drives.

• **Collaboration**: create, edit and delete comments and replies on files.

• **Version history**: list, read, pin (keep forever) and delete file revisions.

• **Change tracking and push notifications**: list changes since a page token, and subscribe (watch) to changes on a file or a whole Drive through webhook channels.

• **Labels**: apply labels to files, set and read label field values, and search by label metadata.

• **Approvals and access proposals**: start, approve, decline, reassign or cancel file approvals; review and resolve requests for access.

• **Application data folder**: store private app configuration in a hidden appDataFolder that the user does not see.

• **Shortcuts**: create Drive shortcuts, including third-party shortcuts that point at data stored outside Drive.

• **Drive UI integration**: appear in Drive's "Open with" and "New" menus; pair with the Google Picker API for file selection.

• **Account information**: storage quota, user info, supported import/export formats (about resource).

• **Long-running operations** and client-side-encryption (CSE) token generation.

3. REST resources and methods

All paths are relative to `https://www.googleapis.com`.

about

Verb	Path	Description
GET	/drive/v3/about	Get info about the user, their Drive and system capabilities.

files

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/files | /upload/drive/v3/files	Create a file (metadata only, or with uploaded content).
GET	/drive/v3/files	List / search the user's files.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}	Get a file's metadata, or content with alt=media.
PATCH	/drive/v3/files/{fileId} | /upload/drive/v3/files/{fileId}	Update metadata, content or both.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/copy	Copy a file, applying updates.
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}	Permanently delete a file (skips trash).
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/trash	Empty the trash.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/download	Download file content (long-running operation).
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/export	Export a Workspace document to another MIME type.
GET	/drive/v3/files/generateIds	Pre-generate file IDs for create/copy.
GET	/drive/v3/files/generateCseToken	Generate a client-side-encryption token.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/listLabels	List labels on a file.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/modifyLabels	Add, change or remove labels on a file.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/watch	Subscribe to changes on a file.

permissions

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/permissions	Share: create a permission.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/permissions	List permissions.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/permissions/{permissionId}	Get a permission.
PATCH	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/permissions/{permissionId}	Update a permission (e.g. change role).
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/permissions/{permissionId}	Remove a permission.

drives (shared drives)

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/drives	Create a shared drive.
GET	/drive/v3/drives	List shared drives.
GET	/drive/v3/drives/{driveId}	Get shared drive metadata.
PATCH	/drive/v3/drives/{driveId}	Update shared drive metadata.
POST	/drive/v3/drives/{driveId}/hide	Hide from default view.
POST	/drive/v3/drives/{driveId}/unhide	Restore to default view.
DELETE	/drive/v3/drives/{driveId}	Permanently delete (organizer only).

comments

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments	Create a comment.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments	List comments.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}	Get a comment.
PATCH	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}	Update a comment.
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}	Delete a comment.

replies

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}/replies	Reply to a comment.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}/replies	List replies.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}/replies/{replyId}	Get a reply.
PATCH	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}/replies/{replyId}	Update a reply.
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/comments/{commentId}/replies/{replyId}	Delete a reply.

revisions

Verb	Path	Description
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/revisions	List revisions.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/revisions/{revisionId}	Get revision metadata or content.
PATCH	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/revisions/{revisionId}	Update a revision (e.g. keepForever).
DELETE	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/revisions/{revisionId}	Permanently delete a revision.

changes

Verb	Path	Description
GET	/drive/v3/changes/startPageToken	Get the starting page token.
GET	/drive/v3/changes	List changes for a user or shared drive.
POST	/drive/v3/changes/watch	Subscribe to changes.

channels

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/channels/stop	Stop a push-notification channel.

approvals

Verb	Path	Description
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals:start	Start an approval.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals	List approvals.
GET	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}	Get an approval.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}:approve	Approve.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}:decline	Decline.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}:cancel	Cancel.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}:comment	Comment on an approval.
POST	/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/approvals/{approvalId}:reassign	Reassign reviewers.

accessproposals

Verb	Path	Description
`GET`	`/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/accessproposals`	List access requests.
`GET`	`/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/accessproposals/{proposalId}`	Get an access request.
`POST`	`/drive/v3/files/{fileId}/accessproposals/{proposalId}:resolve`	Approve or deny it.

apps

Verb	Path	Description
`GET`	`/drive/v3/apps`	List the user's installed Drive apps.
`GET`	`/drive/v3/apps/{appId}`	Get an app.

operations

Verb	Path	Description
`GET`	`/drive/v3/operations/{name}`	Get state of a long-running operation.

4. OAuth 2.0 scopes

Use the narrowest scope you can. Google recommends `drive.file` for most apps. Restricted scopes require app verification and, if data is stored on servers, an annual security assessment.

Scope	Tier	Grants
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.file	Non-sensitive	Files the app creates, or that the user opens/shares with the app (e.g. via Picker).
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.appdata	Non-sensitive	App's own hidden configuration data folder.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.install	Non-sensitive	Appear in Drive's "Open with" / "New" menus.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.apps.readonly	Sensitive	View apps authorized to access the user's Drive.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive	Restricted	Full read/write access to all Drive files.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.readonly	Restricted	View and download all Drive files.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.metadata	Restricted	View and manage file metadata.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.metadata.readonly	Restricted	View file metadata.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.activity	Restricted	View and add to file activity records.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.activity.readonly	Restricted	View file activity records.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.meet.readonly	Restricted	View files created/edited by Google Meet.
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/drive.scripts	Restricted	Modify Apps Script scripts' behaviour.

5. Quick start

• Create or choose a project in the Google Cloud Console.

• Enable **Google Drive API** in APIs & Services > Library.

• Configure the OAuth consent screen and create OAuth client credentials (or a service account).

• Install a client library, e.g. `pip install google-api-python-client google-auth-oauthlib`.

• Call the API, e.g. list 10 files:

```
service = build('drive', 'v3', credentials=creds)
resp = service.files().list(pageSize=10, fields='files(id, name)').execute()
for f in resp['files']: print(f['name'], f['id'])
```

Quotas: the API is free to use, but per-project and per-user request limits apply. Current numbers are on the Usage limits page and in the Cloud Console under Quotas.

6. Official documentation

- **Overview:** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/guides/about-sdk
- **REST reference (v3):** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/reference/rest/v3
- **Choose scopes:** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/guides/api-specific-auth
- **Python quickstart:** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/quickstart/python
- **Usage limits:** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/guides/limits
- **Search query syntax:** https://developers.google.com/workspace/drive/api/guides/search-files
- **API Library entry:** https://console.cloud.google.com/apis/library/drive.googleapis.com

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